

MODERN TECHNOLOGY
Japan's economy is based on high-tech research, development, and production. The country has built up a reputation for providing the latest technology in vehicles and electronic goods such as televisions, computers, and stereo systems. Their products are usually of a high quality but are still affordable.



Prototype of a Mazda car, produced in Hiroshima



MARTIAL ARTS
Kendo is a popular martial art in Japan. It was developed (in its modern form) about 200 years ago and teaches the art of Japanese samurai swordsmanship. Children train using bamboo swords (above).

BASEBALL
Baseball, known as *yakyu*, is fast becoming Japan's most popular sport. As well as two professional leagues, the game is played at universities and schools. It was introduced to Japan in the late 1800s.



A HEALTHY DIET
Rice is the major crop grown on the small amount of flat land in Japan. Along with rice, fish is an important part of most meals, and Japan has one of the world's largest fishing fleets. This healthy diet may be part of the reason why Japanese people have one of the world's longest life expectancy rates.

Sushi, a dish of raw fish and rice



BULLET TRAIN
One of the fastest ways to travel around Japan is on their high-speed train system, known as the bullet trains, or Shinkansen. This network connects Tokyo with most of the country's other major cities, such as Sapporo and Nagasaki. The trains reach speeds of more than 186 mph (300 kph). Japan ran the world's first high-speed train in 1964.

